Q+A

Q. You say your character in *London Diaries* "personally impacted" you. How so?
It was one of the most difficult characters I have played. He has isolated himself from the world, even though he is solving mysteries as a detective. Yes, we all have been isolated through the pandemic, but you still had your family. With this guy, I was left hoping that no one is this lonely in their life. It has been an intense experience.

Q. Are OTT shows now affording you meatier opportunities?
I don't think so. The films that I have done in the past few years have left me spoiled for choice, be it Aparna Sen's *The Rapist*, *Dhaakad*, a period film based on true events that I just completed with Honey Trehan, or *The Battle of Bhima Koregaon*, or even the two projects that I have done with Abbas-Mustan.

Q. You are also doing a film with Telugu star Pawan Kalyan...
When this mega film first came to me, my first reaction was 'I can't do this. How can I speak in another language?' Then I was told that my character doesn't need to speak much Telugu. I just felt that being part of this larger-than-life world, going to another industry and seeing how they work is going to be such a wonderful experience, and that I will only learn from it.

Q. *The Rapist* is leaving quite an impression on the film festival circuit. Tell us about it.
There's a huge process behind doing a film with Aparna Sen—the way she constructs her characters and allows you to explore yours. Konkona [Sensharma] and I hadn't worked together before but the workshops we did allowed us to get to know each other. So, by the time we reached the set, there was camaraderie and an ease.

—with Suhani Singh

SPOILED FOR CHOICE

Even though his new crime thriller, London Diaries, *has just begun streaming on Voot Select, actor* ***Arjun Rampal*** *says it isn't just OTT entertainment that is keeping his hands full*

Photograph by **BANDEEP SINGH**